10.8.3 Some tips for Effective Communication

1. Learn to express yourself

Help others to get to know you better, so they will know what to expect from you. They will also help you to get knowledge because they will give information about themselves.

2. Learn good listening skills

Careful listening avoids misunderstanding. Give your undivided attention to the patient/ speaker. If you need more information ask questions. Be informative by trying to say something positive even if you don't like it.

3. Learn to be assertive

Express what you have to say with frankness without being aggressive. To be assertive means not to say 'Yes' when you want to say 'No'.

CONCLUSION

Communication is a powerful therapeutic tool and an essential nursing skill that influences others and achieves positive health outcomes. Communication is an exchange of a facts, ideas, views, opinions, emotions, informations etc. The basic elements of communication are the referent the sender,the message, the channels, the receiver, the feedback and the environment Nurses use interpersonal, intrapersonal, public and mass interaction to achieve positive change and health goals.

Effective communication helps us to anticipate problems, decisions, co-ordinate workflow, develop relationship and promote services. Barriers of communication may result in failure of the communication process or cause an effect that is undesirable. Communication refers to verbal and non verbal behaviour within a social context. It includes all symbols and clues to give and receive meaning.

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